



FY26 R&D KO Lightning Talks:

IDS, the new UX PO, and expectations of you

Yes, you

Really!



Jon Plummer
Director of UX



Agenda

- IDS!?!+ FYI LOL BRB OMG BBQ PMA FTW
- Our aim
- Our plan
- What this means for you – expectations
- Q&A



IDS!?

- Invoca Design System
- It's here to help us
- Two major parts
 - Front-end component library, based on MUI, delivered as part of Titan, known as "Titan Core"
 - Figma component library
- Supposedly these match, or should, but they don't quite, yet





David Ron

to me

11:08 AM (2 hours ago)



Lightning Talk: Titan Core and Shared Libraries Walkthrough

[View on Google Calendar](#)

When Wed Feb 26, 2025 11:45am – 12pm (PST)

Where <https://invoca.zoom.us/j/95194623223?pwd=UWhnRGY2VkYvSjJRb0drV3NPbExLQT09>

Who The guest list is not available

+1 Yes



Maybe

No

More options

Agenda

Wed Feb 26, 2025

Prev day [Stay: Hotel Santa Barbara, Santa Barbara Confirmation 947099649](#)

8:55am [R&D All Hands Stand Up](#)

11:45am Lightning Talk: Titan Core and Shared Libraries Walkthrough

No later events

This will serve as either a refresher or may be completely new to you. I'll be walking you through the core and shared libraries within Titan, giving a bit of history as to why they exist, and also discuss best practices for using these libraries within your Titan apps. Whether you're new to Titan, have never used Titan, or are a seasoned veteran, I hope you're able to learn something new about how these libraries work together to make building and testing your Titan apps as easy as possible.

When

Wednesday Feb 26, 2025 · 11:45am – 12pm (Pacific Time - Los Angeles)

Location

<https://invoca.zoom.us/j/95194623223?pwd=UWhnRGY2VkYvSjJRb0drV3NPbExLQT09>

[View map](#)

IDS – why

Improve

- Time to deploy/launch/release
- Design & development consistency
- Design & engineering collaboration
- Accessibility & usability at the component level

Reduce

- Inconsistencies in user experience (user expectations, control behavior)
- Tech and design debt through duplication of effort on same/similar front-end patterns
- Siloed FE implementation knowledge



Why IDS, according to UX

- Users benefit from consistent and familiar behavior
 - Consistent control behavior across platform, informed by outside patterns
 - Some usability and most accessibility improvements can be deployed through pattern improvements
- Save money and time in design and development
 - Quicker mocks, more consistent layouts
 - Quicker prototypes for customer feedback and testing
 - Front-ends built of a kit of parts

By the way: UX has greatly increased our design system adherence over the past year+

Easier design/development/improvement of common interfaces allows us to be **more generous with our time and attention**, putting it toward **solving user and customer problems**, making their tasks easier, more direct, and more self-explanatory.



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Director of UX

IDS facts from the perspective of Atlas

- Core components are considered the 'norm' and existing web components are essentially deprecated
 - We consider the design system adopted from a dev POV
 - Overrides are minimal and infrequent – deviation requests negatively impact project timelines
 - Some components exist in Titan to enable migrating legacy apps
- Roadmap items related to Titan Core Components are usually 20% or less of work total team roadmap
 - Mostly Keeping Lights On work (dependency upgrades MUI, React, Node, etc.)
- Additions to component library are governed by UX team
- Atlas doesn't need to interact with most UI-heavy projects – exceptions for when augmentations to existing components are necessary or new global elements are identified
- Dev/QA cycle using Titan is much simpler and dramatically faster than using Web
- Guidelines distributed through Figma are integrated into Storybook as interactive references – Figma is source of truth

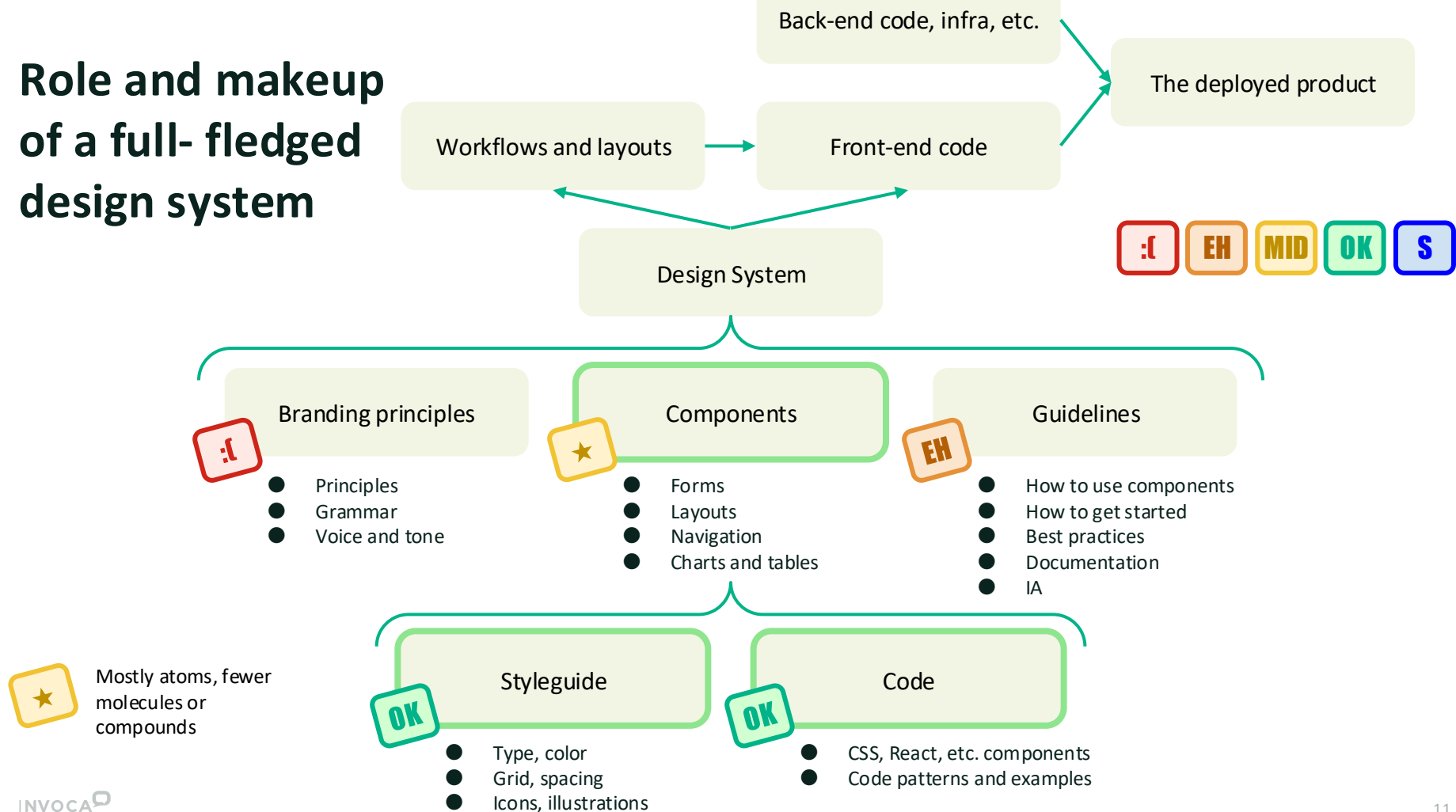


Titan value as of 2024-11-22

- Frontend Web changes have decreased since Titan's inception
 - Jan 1 - Nov 22, 2021: 3337
 - Jan 1 - Nov 22, 2022: 2578
 - Jan 1 - Nov 22, 2023: 839
 - Jan 1 - Nov 22, 2024: 338 🎉 (That's a 90% decrease in 3 years)
- 1,830 instances of Titan Core components integrated into modern Titan React apps. If components were built as one-offs, estimated at roughly 90 minutes per component, rough time saved is 164,700 dev minutes, not counting design + hidden costs
 - Frontend: From "Code Complete" to "Deployed"
 - Web: Best case, 0 failures, 90 minutes – 35 min PR build + 35 min mainline build + 20 min deploy
 - Titan: 12 minutes – 6 min PR build + 6 min deploy
- 1,162 Titan Deploys since January 1, 2024
 - Time to deploy in Web: 104,580 minutes
 - Time to deploy in Titan: 13,944 minutes
 - A savings of 1,510 hours



Role and makeup of a full- fledged design system



Our aims

Tackle issues...

- Some teams are better than others at using patterns, using tokens, avoiding needless customization (UX and engineering) – knowledge and commitment unevenly distributed
- Gaps between Figma and Storybook lead to confusion
- Parts of IDS are over-complicated (button, for example)
- Design System work typically gets deprioritized, limping along on Nicole's discretionary effort

...implying these goals

- Raise UX understanding and commitment
- Provide help and coaching to scrum teams to raise proficiency
- Fix split ownership problem
- Close gaps between Figma and Storybook
- Allocate actual % of UX time to IDS
- Set expectations clearly

Our plan

In a nutshell: **a UX person as IDS Product Owner (PO)**

- Six month term, rotating
- 50% time – requires limiting large initiatives for the person in the role
- Goals and duties
 - Manage the IDS roadmap and backlog
 - Steadily improve accessibility, usability, and consistency of existing patterns
 - Steadily improve adherence to, and suitability of, the design system
 - Be a resource to teams
 - Help with exceptions



Brittany Choy

UX Designer

First IDS PO

STARTED ALREADY

Nota bene

**This isn't a *proposal*, it's a
pilot**



What about Nicole?

- **Not responsible** until it's her turn in the rotation
 - (i.e., don't bug her, bug Brittany)
- A knowledgeable and trusted advisor to the IDS PO who can manage her own availability
- More available to initiatives and enhancements
- More strategic
- Not pulled in so many directions



Nicole Conary
Staff UX Designer

What about Jon?

- Will help PO with priorities and plan, adapting to business needs
- Will monitor process and help PO and Atlas adapt

Expectations of IDS PO and Atlas

IDS PO

- Watch for exceptions and take note of them
- Expose what the system does that might work, offer alternatives, as a resource to trios and designers
- Manage the IDS backlog and adapt to company and team needs
- Plan and negotiate DS/PL improvements with Atlas
- Negotiate DoD with Atlas
- Be available to de-legacy projects to reduce customization (1:1 is not the goal)

Atlas

- Watch for exceptions and take note of them
- Expose what the system does that might work, offer alternatives, as a resource to trios and engineers
- Contribute to IDS backlog
- Plan and negotiate DS/PL improvements with the PO
- Negotiate DoD with PO
- Involve PO in de-legacy projects to reduce customization (1:1 is not the goal)

Expectations common to UX and engineers

- Use components, use tokens, avoid primitives and magic numbers – Figma DevMode helps
- Avoid customization and detaches...
 - ...unless you have a good reason...
 - ...which must be negotiated, starting from user and customer needs
 - If you NEED something special negotiate it within your scrum team and know that y'all are responsible for it unless/until it becomes a pattern later
- Even a basic Titanization project benefits from reducing unnecessary customization
 - We're not trying to copy legacy stuff, we're trying to bring it up-to-date
- Seek advice on how to accomplish what you are thinking in a patterny way from the IDS PO and from Atlas
- Don't make or lobby for new IDS patterns ahead of repeated use (every time we've done that it has created waste)

Moving forward, not copying the past,
even in a mixed environment

Nota bene

Don't pattern in advance.

YAGNI

You Aren't Gonna Need It

Nota bene

The platform will naturally
lead the design system

Expectations of trio

Prefer what can be made of existing components, but don't do something barbarous or that doesn't meet customer needs in the name of strict adherence

- Instead, frame tempting exceptions in terms of customer problems for the trio to figure out
 - ideally prior to development starting in earnest (but in general as soon as the need arises emerges)
- PM makes the scope/timing/functionality tradeoff call if necessary



<https://sites.duke.edu/scientificwriting/orwells-6-rules/>

Q&A

What questions do
you have?

